

2023.7.26 上午场

Your professor is teaching a class on marketing. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

Let's continue talking about consumer behavior. We have been discussing different ways people go about choosing what products to buy, and there are many potential sources of information and advice for consumers. In your opinion, which is the better strategy for making purchasing decisions, relying on advice from friends and family, or depending on information from online sources? Why?

Claire:

Asking friends and family members for product recommendations might seem like an easier option, but it might take too much time to get all the information you need.

An internet search would be much more efficient. There are many consumer magazines available online that compile lots of data to compare the advantages and disadvantages of one product versus another.

Paul:

The last time I bought a computer, I just watched a few videos online to make a decision, and now I regret that. My friends could have advised me better because they know my preferences and the kind of features that I am interested in.

Consumers should get advice from the people around them to find the most suitable products.

2023.7.26 下午场

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
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An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Gupta:

This week, we discussed the importance of role models and opinion makers in society.

One idea we discussed was the widespread impact of "influencers." Influencers are people who are very active posting on social media and who have many followers. Influencers' posts and opinions can influence their followers' choices on everything from fashion to politics you're your opinion.do social media influencers generally have a positive or negative effect on their followers? Why do you think so?

Claire:

I think the influencers' effect is generally positive. People can learn about the latest trends and topics in a very quick and efficient way by following influencers. In the past, people had to spend time looking through magazines or visiting boutiques to even know what was trending.

Paul:

I think influencers generally have a negative effect because they have far too much influence. I can think of one influencer who only has to mention a particular kind of sports shoe. and the next day they'll be sold out. The followers aren't really thinking for themselves; they're just blindly following their influencers' choices.

2023.7.30 亚太卷

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

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An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Diaz:

This week, we'll be discussing ways to address air pollution. One idea is introducing environmental taxes on air travel. Such taxes, also referred to as ecological taxes or green taxes, are extra charges that get added to the price of airplane tickets. Money collected from these taxes could be invested in environmentally friendly technologies or in promoting others, cleaner modes of transportation. Do you think there should be an environmental tax on air travel? Why or why not?

Andrew:

We should impose environmental taxes on air travel. These taxes might encourage people to find cheaper, more eco-friendly ways to get places. In my country, many people use planes to fly a short distance because flights are relatively cheap, when they could just as easily take a less polluting form of transportation.

Claire:

Additional taxes on air travel will do little to solve the problem of air pollution. Airplane tickets would become more expensive, punishing passengers without incentivizing airlines to become more environmentally friendly. The airlines should pay the price to protect the environment, not their customers.

2023.08.01 亚太卷

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

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Doctor Diaz:

We've been discussing government budgets and the difficult decisions governments must make regarding the use of public funds. Some services are clearly essential and must be paid for by any government. But what about public funding of the arts? Do you believe that governments should provide financial support to artists—for example, painters, sculptors, musicians, or filmmakers? Why or why not?

Claire:

I enjoy art as much as anyone does, but public funds come from taxes, and I don't think taxpayers' hard-earned money should be spent on impractical or inessential items and services. Artists should support themselves by selling their work to private individuals and companies. If they can't find enough buyers, then maybe they should change careers.

Paul:

Personally, I think art actually is essential. Lots of public spaces in my hometown just wouldn't be the same without artwork. From statues in public parks to murals painted on the walls of government buildings, my hometown really benefits from funding the artists who created these works. The public spaces are simply more enjoyable for visitors because of the artwork.

2023.08.02 北美卷

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

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Dr.Achebe

In the next few weeks, we'll be talking about urban traffic management. Let's begin by discussing one popular idea-creating car-free central zones. Some cities around the world have recently designated their downtown areas as being automobile-free, which means that vehicles are not allowed to enter the city centers. Do you think that more cities should make their central zones car-free? Why or why not?

Claire

I support the idea of establishing free-car zones, because this will result in one important benefit because this will result in one important benefit for city residents: it will be better for their health. Instead of driving everywhere, people will be encouraged to walk or cycle more. It would be a great way to incorporate exercise into people's routines.

Paul

It sounds like a good idea, but I'm skeptical. My main concern is that many businesses located in the city centers, such as shops and restaurants, may suffer because the customers will no longer be able to reach those businesses by car. For some customers, if they can't drive, they won't go at all.

amenities they need.

2023.08.06 家考

Your professor is teaching a class on parenting. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

This week we covered different parenting styles. One idea we discussed was how much independence and freedom we should give our children, especially young children. One related issue is whether there should be an age limit on when children can have mobile phones. In this discussion post, I would like you to discuss whether you agree or disagree with the idea of setting a minimum age for when children can

have a mobile phone. Explain your opinion.

Andrew

I totally agree with the idea of not giving children phones before they reach a certain age, let's say ten years or so. I believe children younger than ten are not yet ready to deal with the world that comes with mobile phones, as it can put them in harm's way.

Claire

Honestly, I am against the idea of restricting mobile phone access for young children. I believe mobile phones can help children communicate with their parents if they need their help for an urgent matter when they are away from their parents at school or elsewhere. Maybe companies can invent a special kind of mobile phone that is somehow kid friendly.

2023.08.09 家考

Your professor is teaching a class on marketing. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Gupta

We are looking this week at different ways businesses market their products and services, especially nontraditional methods. One thing that marketers pay close attention to is online reviews of their products. A business might include customer reviews on their website or carefully monitor the reviews on third-party sites. I would like you to discuss your own experiences with online reviews. Do you find them useful when deciding whether or not to buy a product or service? Why or why not?

Andrew

I think online reviews are a great source of information because they are written by ordinary customers who are like me. For instance, when I read a restaurant review by professional food critics, I'm not interested in some of the details that are included, like how the food is prepared. I'm more interested in aspects like the quality of the food and the service, which regular customers usually comment on.

Claire

To me, online reviews have some real problems. First people are more likely to post reviews after a bad experience than after a good one. As a result, what you read is

often weighted toward the negative. Also, you have no way of knowing whether reviewers know what they are talking about or even if they actually bought and used the product they are reviewing.

2023.08.09 亚太卷

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr.Achebe

This week, we'll examine issues in education reform. For example, some educators think that by focusing mainly on foundational knowledge in subjects like reading, math, and science, schools are not fully preparing students for success in the workplace. These educators argue that soft skills-non academic skills such as empathetic or having a strong work ethic-should be part of the curriculum, with classroom time dedicated to developing these skills. Do you agree? Why or why not?

Claire

I agree. While students need a strong foundation in academic subjects, soft skills are important because they affect how well students do their work. If classroom time is set aside for these skills, students will take them seriously and their academic work will benefit. Teachers could design lessons so that students learn about a skill and then do role-playing activities with classmates.

Andrew

Soft skills are important, but I don't agree with using classroom time to work on them. I'm not sure how teachers would measure students' progress in developing these skills. If students' progress can't be measured on something being taught, I'm not sure if there's any point to teaching it.

2023.08.09 家考

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Diaz

Some educators think that in our global, tech-oriented world, students need to focus on nonfiction texts, such as news stories, technical manuals, or other informational materials. They say that reading poetry, novels, and short stories is not the optimal use of the limited time that students have in the classroom. How do you view this approach to education? Should schools limit the teaching of fictional texts in favor of teaching more practical, nonfiction texts?

Andrew

Education has to evolve. Nowadays there's an enormous amount of economic and political data freely available online. It's important that students can evaluate this information to understand local and world events in order to be good citizens. Reading fiction is a wonderful hobby but school should prepare students for adult life and its responsibilities.

Claire

I spent a lot of class time in high school analyzing literature. I'm studying to be an engineer, so I admit that reading fiction in school was not directly applicable to my future occupation, but it did instill in me a love of reading, which is very valuable. I feel better equipped now to understand all sorts of written material.

2023.08.11 家考

Your professor is teaching a class on self-care. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Professor Diaz

This week we talked about how important taking time off from work or school is for people's well-being. Some people believe they get the most benefit when that time off is structured: that is it involves planning in advance about what will be accomplished on that day. Others believe it is better to enjoy the day with no plan for how to spend it. In this discussion post please indicate which of those approaches to spending time off from work or school you prefer and why?

Claire

I find it beneficial to do some advance planning for my free time. I live far away from my family so when I am getting ready to visit them during a school holiday always plan my time off from school very carefully. That way I have enough time to visit with each family member.

Paul

Personally, I prefer not to make any plans for my free time. I go to school, and I have a part-time job each week. I make a schedule to be sure I can complete both my work and studies. So when I have time off from work and school, I just want to relax with no plan.

2023.08.13 家考

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

Secondary or high school students (ages 14-18) who plan to attend university must begin thinking about what field of study they'll enter. Some students might be directed into certain fields by their parents and teachers. Others prefer to make their own choice based on their own interests and feelings. Do you believe that secondary school students should be allowed to choose their own field of study at university without being guided by parents and teachers? Why?

Kelly

I think it's a mistake to let students at that age make such an important decision on their own. They usually don't have the wisdom to choose appropriately. The people who know them best, their parents and teachers, will be more objective and give the best guidance.

Andrew

Choosing a field of study, and perhaps a career in that field, based mainly on what others tell you to do seems wrong to me. My parents wanted me to study engineering, but I'm not interested in that; I want to help people learn. I know I'll struggle more financially as a teacher, but I'm sure I'll be happier.

2023.08.15

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Diaz:

Many countries are facing budget constraints due to slowed economic growth and increased spending on social services. With limited resources, governments must prioritize how to allocate funding across sectors like education, healthcare, defense, infrastructure, and more. Keeping budget constraints in mind, what areas of spending do you think your government should reduce first in order to balance the budget? Please explain your rationale.

Andrew:

I think one way our city could save money without hurting important stuff like schools and roads is to cut down on extra workers at city hall. With money being tight, it seems like we have some people in city jobs that aren't really needed. If they cut back on some of those extra administrative people through retirement or layoffs, it could really help the budget without taking away anything important. I'm sure there's at least some fat they could trim at city hall without hurting the regular services people need.

Claire:

I think one way our city could save some money on park costs is by changing the plants in the grass to types that don't need a lot of care and water. If they use plants that don't need to be maintained as much instead of fancy flowers and stuff, they wouldn't have to pay to water and trim them as often. That could add up to decent savings since keeping parks looking nice can take a lot of work. Switching to tougher, lower-maintenance plants seems like an easy way to cut back on how much the city spends to take care of the grass and plants.

2023.08.16 家考

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

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- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr.Achebe

In many countries, the standard workweek consists of eight hours of work each day for five days per week. Now, though, some people advocate a shorter work week: a four-day workweek with no decrease in workers' pay. There are advantages and disadvantages to this of course. What is your opinion about instituting a shorter four-day workweek, and why?

Kelly

i like that idea, but on one condition: that the workday is no longer than eight hours. I have heard some plans require ten hours a day for a four-day week. Most employees would find that exhausting, and it could actually be counterproductive to tire out your workers. Yes to four-day weeks, but no to ten-hour days!

Andrew

In my country, the workweek is Monday to Friday plus half a day on Saturday, so moving to a four-day workweek would be too drastic a change! Workers might struggle to complete their tasks in a four-day workweek. It seems less stressful to spread work out over more days rather than trying to condense it all into a shorter week.

2023.08.19 上午场

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Diaz:

In today's context, there's a growing consensus that education should extend beyond high school and college, encompassing lifelong learning. Imagine you're a student engaging with this topic. Your input is sought on which specific field adults should focus on for ongoing education. Given this perspective, the question to you is: Considering the shift towards lifelong education, which field of study do you believe adults should prioritize for their continuous learning journey?

Andrew:

In my opinion, it's important for adults to have the opportunity to take foreign language classes as part of their lifelong education. Learning a new language can open doors to different cultures, enhance communication skills, and boost career prospects. Plus, it's a way to keep our minds active and engaged throughout our lives. So, I believe offering foreign language courses to adults is a valuable way to support

their continuous learning journey.

Claire:

I think art classes should definitely be available to adults as part of lifelong education. Engaging in art allows us to express ourselves, relieve stress, and tap into our creativity. Even if someone didn't have the chance to explore art when they were younger, providing these classes to adults can offer them away to discover new talents, develop new hobbies, and continue growing personally, no matter their age.

2023.08.19 下午场

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Diaz:

As you approach graduation, you may be considering your next steps for further education. Some opt to enroll full-time to complete an advanced degree as quickly as possible. Others choose to work while slowly progressing towards a degree. Given these options, I'm curious to know your thoughts. After finishing your undergraduate studies, do you prefer pursuing an advanced degree full-time or continuing work while studying part-time?

Andrew:

I think it's better to go to college full-time instead of trying to balance part-time classes and a full-time job. For me, I know I wouldn't be able to focus on my studies if I was exhausted from work all the time. Full-time college allows me to put all my energy into my classes and get the most out of my education. Trying to do both college and work full-time seems way too stressful for me to handle. I'd rather get my degree done faster by being a full-time student.

Claire:

I think going to college part-time while working is better because I can use what I learn in class at my job right away. The classes feel more relevant when I'm able to apply the material to real work situations. Instead of just memorizing concepts, I get to see how they work in practice. And getting work experience while I study looks good on my resume. I think balancing the two helps me get more out of my classes and prepares me for my career at the same time. I'd rather take classes part-time and work than just study full-time.

2023.08.21 家考

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Dr. Achebe

Today, we are going to discuss how successful software and tech products are launched and marketed. When companies launch and market these products, early adopters are important. Early adopters are customers who tend to buy the latest products and like to be the first to try out new features and processes. In today's discussion, I would like you to describe at least one advantage or disadvantage of being an early adopter. Please explain why you think this way.

Kelly

One obvious disadvantage is that early adopters probably pay a lot more for brand-new technology. When products first come out, they're often quite expensive, but once they've been on the market for a while, the price usually drops. That's why I usually wait to buy new technology.

Andrew

New tech products might not always be more expensive -- sometimes the company will give people a new product at a discount in exchange for trying it out and giving feedback on it. In fact, to me, that's the biggest advantage of being an early adopter: your feedback can guide future improvements to a product. That's a powerful

feeling.

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Dr. Achebe

This week in class, we are discussing how concern about the environment is affecting consumer behavior. One recent trend in some countries is that consumers are trying to reuse products and materials as much as possible; for example, by buying used clothing or a used car instead of a new one. In your posts, I want you to discuss either an advantage or a disadvantage of buying used or recycled products as opposed to new ones.

Kelly

Besides the benefits to the environment, one advantage is that many vintage, previously owned products, have more charm. For example, old furniture has a lot of character and history, and it always makes a room more interesting. People can even make furniture from reclaimed materials, like making a table from an old wooden door, which always looks unique.

Andrew

Buying used products has its drawbacks. New products are backed by the company that made them. If you buy a new washing machine and it does not work properly, the company will replace or repair it. If you buy something used and it breaks, it's your responsibility to fix it and the parts are not always available.

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Doctor Diaz:

This week, we'll be discussing ways to address air pollution. One idea is introducing environmental taxes on air travel. Such taxes, also referred to as ecological taxes or green taxes, are extra charges that get added to the price of airplane tickets. Money collected from these taxes could be invested in environmentally friendly technologies or in promoting other, cleaner modes of transportation. Do you think there should be an environmental tax on air travel? Why or why not?

Andrew:

We should impose environmental taxes on air travel. These taxes might encourage people to find cheaper, more eco-friendly ways to get places. In my country, many

people use planes to fly a short distance because flights are relatively cheap, when they could just as easily take a less polluting form of transportation.

Claire:

Additional taxes on air travel will do little to solve the problem of air pollution. Airplane tickets would become more expensive, punishing passengers without incentivizing airlines to become more environmentally friendly. The airlines should pay the price to protect the environment, not their customers.

2023.08.26

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Doctor Achebe:

Many companies provide important products and services but at the same time cause environmental damage. Some people believe the way to prevent these companies from damaging the environment is for the government to require more penalties from them, such as higher taxes and larger fines. Do you think it is a good idea?

Andrew:

A lot of companies make helpful products but hurt the environment too. I think the government should punish them more, like raising their taxes and fines, to stop the damage. Doing that would hold corporations accountable and force them to change in an impactful way. We can have both innovation and sustainability if governments incentivize it properly through penalties.

Claire:

disagree that we should penalize corporations more for environmental damage. Many companies are already taking steps to adopt greener practices. and higher taxes or fines could discourage innovation and hurt the economy. Instead of punishing businesses, I believe the government should reward and incentivize sustainable choices through subsidies and tax breaks.

2023.08.27

Your professor is teaching a class on business, Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following

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An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

Let's explore the concept of retail and its variations. In the world of retail, there's a unique type where a wide array of products are housed under one roof, allowing for wholesale purchases. This brings us to the idea of super stores. On the other end, we have small stores catering to specific needs. Now, considering these options, which one do you think holds more advantages for people? Would the convenience of super stores outweigh the personal touch of small stores?

Claire:

In my opinion, super stores hold an edge over small stores due to their wide-ranging product choices, extended hours, and cost-saving options. As a student juggling classes and activities, the convenience of finding everything under one roof and the potential for bulk discounts make superstores a practical choice. While small stores offer a personal touch, the efficiency and budget-friendly nature of super stores align better with my busy college lifestyle.

Andrew:

In my view, small stores outweigh super stores, mainly due to the emphasis on personalized service and repairs. The direct assistance and expertise offered by small stores are invaluable, especially when it comes to electronics or gadgets that might need fixing. While super stores provide convenience, the hands-on support and tailored solutions from small stores align better with my college experience and budget considerations.

2023.08.28 家考

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Dr. Achebe

In the past, progresses in science and technology were generally slow. However in recent decades, the pace of technological progress has dramatically accelerated, with new discoveries and inventions almost every day. Some argue that the rapid

advancement of science and technology is beneficial for society as a whole and should be encouraged. Others believe that this progress is happening too quickly and may lead to serious issues. Which viewpoint do you agree with?

Kelly

The faster the discoveries, the better. For example, due to advancements in medicine, our lives are much better than those of our great-grandparents. Back then, life expectancy was significantly shorter due to a lack of medication, whereas today, drugs are affordable and accessible. Anyone with a severe illness hopes for rapid scientific progress.

Andrew

Most people don't have a say in the implementation of these new inventions and that fact worries me. Just think about the widespread unemployment caused by the automation of many jobs: in this era of rapid technological change, it has become commonplace. People who lose their jobs may not believe that this progress is

beneficial.

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Paul:

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Dr. Achebe

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Claire

I support the idea of establishing free-car zones, because this will result in one important benefit because this will result in one important benefit for city residents: it will be better for their health. Instead of driving everywhere, people will be encouraged to walk or cycle more. It would be a great way to incorporate exercise into people's routines.

Paul

It sounds like a good idea, but I'm skeptical. My main concern is that many businesses located in the city centers, such as shops and restaurants, may suffer because the customers will no longer be able to reach those businesses by car. For

some customers, if they can't drive, they won't go at all.

2023.09.03 家考

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

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Doctor Achebe:

This week, we'll examine issues in education reform. For example, some educators think that by focusing mainly on foundational knowledge in subjects like reading, math, and science, schools are not fully preparing students for success in the workplace. These educators argue that soft skills-non-academic skills such as being empathetic or having a strong work ethic - should be part of the curriculum, with classroom time dedicated to developing these skills. Do you agree? Why or why not?

Paul:

Soft skills are important, but I don't agree with using classroom time to work on them. I'm not sure how teachers would measure students' progress in developing these skills. If students' progress can't be measured on something being taught, I'm not sure if there's any point to teaching it.

Claire:

I agree. While students need a strong foundation in academic subjects, soft skills are important because they affect how well students do their work. If classroom time is set aside for these skills, students will take them seriously and their academic work will benefit. Teachers could design lessons so that students learn about a skill and then do role-playing activities with classmates.

2023.09.06

Your professor is teaching a class on biology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

In the next two weeks, we are going to be studying how biological discoveries have affected our lives. Research in biology provides us with a better understanding of how our bodies work. As an introduction to this topic, I would like for you to discuss

among yourselves this question: What is the most important thing a person can do to maintain good health? Please explain why you think so.

Claire:

I feel very strongly that a good diet is the most important factor in maintaining good health. Eating good, healthy foods, especially green vegetables, gives your body the materials it needs to stay strong. Good nutrition is the key to good health.

Paul:

Most people don't visit the doctor for regular checkups. Sure, if they feel sick, they go, but that's not enough. During a yearly exam, a physician can help a patient address health issues before they become a larger problem. So I think preventive doctor visits are key to good health.

2023.09.09

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

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- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

Local governments have limited budgets to spend on enriching residents' lives. Supporting arts programs like concerts and museums offers cultural engagement, while funding recreational activities like hiking trails and parks promotes healthy lifestyles. As students who appreciate culture and wellness, let's discuss whether local funding should support arts programs or recreational activities more. Which do you think better serves the community and why?

Kelly:

I think local governments should prioritize spending on outdoor trails and parks rather than arts programs like museums and concerts. More people would use and benefit from improved recreation spaces than arts venues. If fewer residents are interested in the arts, they won't attend museums or concerts even if government funds them.

Andrew:

I believe local governments should actually prioritize spending on arts programs like museums and concerts rather than recreation. Precisely because fewer residents are inherently interested in the arts, public funding is essential to sustain these cultural institutions for the minority who appreciate them. Without support, access to the arts will decline and society will lose these enriching, enduring outlets for creative expression.

2023.09.10

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

Express and support your opinion.

Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor :

Today we will discuss a topic that is important for students and the public at large: namely, how to prioritize spending, given the limited funding available for schools. Some people think schools should spend more money on schoolteachers' salaries because, if the salaries improved, more qualified people will be attracted to the profession. Others believe the money should be spent on additional resources such as books and computers. Which viewpoint do you agree with?

Kelly:

I believe that increasing schoolteachers' pay would increase the quality of education. If they made more money, people would consider teaching as a profession instead of going into private industry. We need our smartest people in the classroom.

Paul:

I think school teachers already make enough money and already deliver high-quality education. I'm not sure that increasing their salaries would have much effect. However, schools are always in need of new equipment or facilities. Knowledge and technology are always growing and changing, and we need to prepare students with the most up-to-date materials possible.

2023.09.16 上午场

Dr. Achebe

More and more, online shopping is becoming the primary way that many people obtain everyday goods. But what are the ramifications for the society in which we

live? On the one hand, online shopping has advantages-for example, I can make a purchase without ever leaving my home. However, with fewer people shopping at local shops, in some places, these establishments are having a hard time competing. Do you think that online shopping is, on the whole, affecting society?

Andrew:

I think that online shopping has had negative impacts on society. In my city, many local stores have shelves filled with various products that you can find in online stores. This has forced some of them to closedown, which not only affects the

amount of tax revenue generated in our local community but also impacts the number of job opportunities available to the community members.

Kelly:

It's unfortunate that some local stores are forced to close down, but that's the nature of competition. As consumers, we benefit greatly from online shopping due to lower prices. Even if I find a physical store that can compete with online sellers in terms of pricing, I am still likely to make the purchase online because it means i don't have to spend money on transportation to the store.

2023.09.17 上午场

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

Express and support your opinion.

Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor:

As of this semester, I have embarked on a study to explore the various factors influencing children's cognition. It's becoming increasingly evident that a child's surroundings can significantly impact their development. In light of this, the question arises: should parents allow their children to watch online videos, whether for entertainment or educational purposes? Please share your insights on this matter, considering the potential effects on a child's cognitive growth.

Paul:

We should not allow young children, especially those under two years old, to watch videos. It's crucial for their development to engage in real-life communication with others during this critical period. Watching videos doesn't provide the opportunity for meaningful interaction. Even for older children, it's essential to prioritize physical activity over extended screen time. Instead of sitting still in front of screens, they should be encouraged to stay active to support their overall well-being.

Kelly:

I agree that very young children shouldn't be exposed to videos. However, I believe that older children can benefit from watching certain videos, especially those that showcase animals or provide unique insights not easily encountered in everyday life. These videos can be educational and expand their horizons by offering a window into experiences they might not otherwise have access to.

2023.09.17 下午场

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

Express and support your opinion.

Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

In recent years, we've witnessed rapid advancements in science and technology that have transformed various aspects of our lives. These advancements bring about both opportunities and challenges. Now, let's delve into a critical question: Is the rapid pace of technological progress a positive or negative development? Please share your thoughts on whether you believe the fast-paced nature of scientific and technological advancements is ultimately beneficial or detrimental to society, and provide reasons to support your perspective.

Paul:

Certainly. Take, for instance, the field of healthcare. Medical advancements have significantly improved our quality of life and extended our lifespans. These innovations include breakthrough treatments, precision medicine, and cutting-edge medical technologies. As a result, diseases that were once fatal can now be managed or even cured. The increased longevity and enhanced well-being resulting from medical progress are compelling reasons to view rapid technological advancement as a positive force in our society.

Kelly:

Indeed, there are concerns associated with the rapid pace of technological progress. One significant drawback is the potential for job displacement. As technology advances, some traditional jobs become obsolete, leading to unemployment for certain segments of the population. This issue of job loss raises questions about income inequality and the need for retraining programs to equip workers with new skills. Thus, it's essential to recognize that while progress is valuable, it also requires measures to address its adverse consequences.

2023.09.18 家考

Your professor is teaching a class. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

Express and support your opinion.

Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Daiz:

This week, we covered the future of education in a global world. We discussed whether schools should focus on equipping students with skills that will help them be successful anywhere in the world. These skills include being respectful of unfamiliar cultures and studying the history of those cultures. In your post, I would like you to discuss whether schools should make it a priority to prepare students for a global society. Please explain your opinion.

Claire:

To not forget my true identity, students should prioritize learning the values cherished in their local culture. Attempting to cultivate global citizens may result in students losing their own identities. Only after schools have provided students with a solid foundation in the history of their local culture can they then focus on studying the histories of other countries.

Kelly:

Technology has made it easier than ever for people to connect with the world. Therefore, we anticipate that more individuals will work in countries other than their own and benefit from acquiring global skills that will help them succeed anywhere.

2023.09.20

重复 2023.08.11 家考

2023.09.23

Your professor is teaching a class. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

Express and support your opinion.

Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

This week in class we are learning about different methods of advertising and their effectiveness. One advertising strategy that companies often use is to ask celebrities, famous entertainers or sports figures to promote their products. However some experts believe that it is more effective to have ordinary people talk about the product. Which of these two advertising strategies do you think is better?

Paul

I like the "ordinary people" approach. People are more interested in a product when they see people like themselves using the product. I think this is even true for clothing advertisements, which traditionally use famous models. People get a better idea of whether they like the clothes when they see kinds of different people wearing them, and not just models

Claire

I think the use of celebrities is really effective. The first thing an advertisement must do is grab viewers' attention. When a famous actor or sports figure appears in your advertisement, viewers first notice the celebrity, "what's this? I really like that person." they think. Then, once you have the viewers, you can provide information about your product.

2023.09.24

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

Express and support your opinion.

Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

In recent years, with the increasing prevalence of online payment methods, we've seen a significant decrease in the use of cash for everyday transactions. This shift has prompted a debate about whether it's a positive or negative development. So, let me pose this question to you: With the decrease in cash usage due to the rise of online

payments, do you consider this trend to be positive or negative? Why or why not?

Paul:

This is indeed a positive development because it offers tremendous convenience. We can complete transactions with just our smartphones, eliminating the need to carry a wallet full of cash and coins. This convenience not only streamlines our daily routines but also reduces the risk of theft or loss associated with physical cash.

Claire:

This trend is negative because it disconnects us from our spending habits. When we use cash, we have a tangible sense of how much money we're spending, which helps us keep track of our expenses. With digital payments, it's easier to lose sight of our financial transactions, potentially leading to overspending and financial mismanagement.

alternatives, offer clear benefits for people in their everyday lives.

2023.09.26

重复 2023.08.21 家考

2023.10.10

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

Outdoor education can have various benefits, such as connecting with nature and learning in a different environment. As part of an initiative to encourage more outdoor learning, there is a proposal to have teachers take students aged 5-18 outside of the classroom for outdoor classes once a month. In your response, please share your thoughts on whether outdoor classes once a month would be beneficial for students in this age group.

Kelly

We should avoid burdening teachers with additional responsibilities during instructional time. Teachers are already tasked with delivering quality education and

managing classrooms effectively. Adding more duties, such as administrative tasks or non-teaching responsibilities, can divert their focus from teaching. Instead, we should prioritize supporting teachers in their primary role.

Andrew

Hands-on learning outside the classroom can help students understand environmental problems in a tangible way and spark their interest to learn more. For example, measuring air or water quality in local areas impacted by pollution can vividly demonstrate environmental threats. Outdoor learning experiences make environmental issues real to students, motivating them to care about finding solutions.

2023.10 . 14

Your professor is teaching a class on public policies. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Local governments have limited budgets to spend on enriching residents' lives. Supporting arts programs like concerts and museums offers cultural engagement, while funding outdoor activities like building hiking trails and playgrounds promotes healthy lifestyles. Now, let's discuss whether local funding should support arts programs or outdoor activities more. Which do you think better serves the community and why?

Amy

I think local governments should prioritize spending on trails and playgrounds rather than arts programs like museums and concerts. More people would use and benefit from improved outdoors recreational facilities than arts venues. Since many residents probably aren't even that interested in the arts, they won't go to museums or concerts even if government funds them.

Rory

I believe local governments should actually prioritize spending on arts programs. Precisely because fewer residents are inherently interested in the arts, public funding is essential to sustain these cultural institutions for the minority who appreciate them. Without support, access to the arts will decline and society will lose these enriching, enduring outlets for creative expression.

2023.10.16

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

In project-based learning, students acquire and demonstrate knowledge and skills by working on a course-related project, typically with other students. Before our class tomorrow, I'd like your opinion: Do you think project-based learning is more effective at promoting learning than the traditional lecture method?

Amy

I find the traditional lecture method to be more effective because the information students need to know is given to them directly.

Rory

I think the process of project-based learning is more effective at helping you develop useful skills, especially interpersonal skills that can be helpful in your career.

10.17 家考考场真题

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Gupta:

To continue our discussion of the health benefits of good nutrition, I'd like you to consider the broader topic of eating habits-not just what people eat and drink, but how often, how much, and when. Those who want to improve their health often begin by changing some kind of eating habit. This includes a wide range of behavior. What is one poor eating habit that would be important for most people to change, and why?

Kelly:

If people could start with one change to improve their eating habits, it would be to eat a better breakfast. Most people are so rushed in the morning that they don't take the time to sit down and eat a balanced meal. A good breakfast gives you more energy all day and keeps you from eating too much later on.

Paul:

I think most people don't bother to learn much about the food that they eat. This ignorance is a

kind of bad eating habit. It can be burdensome, but you should try to read every food package label. The more you can learn about what you're putting in your body, the more likely you'll be to make good decisions.

10.18 线下考场真题

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words. An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

This week, we'll be discussing the future of education. Let's focus now on the following viewpoint: it is no longer useful to spend many years pursuing a traditional, specialized university degree in a single field, such as communications or economics. Instead, it makes more sense for most people to complete several shorter certification programs and earn certificates in, for example, project management, computer programming, graphic design, and so on. Do you agree or disagree with this viewpoint? Why?

Kelly:

I strongly support this approach because it aligns with the changing preferences of many individuals in the modern world who often wish to switch majors or career paths. Embracing certification programs allows people to explore and pursue the fields they are passionate about without the commitment of lengthy degree programs.

Andrew:

University education is a superior choice due to its comprehensive and specialized nature. While certification programs offer quick training, universities provide a more in-depth understanding of a subject. They encourage critical thinking, research skills, and a broader knowledge base. University degrees often lead to higher earning potential and career opportunities.

2023.10.21 上午场

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

What should children be learning in school? Many people believe that time in the classroom should be spent acquiring foundational knowledge in subjects like math, reading, science, and history. Others feel that it's important for a child's creativity to be nurtured, and thus the school curriculum must include classes in art and music.

There's so much to learn, yet so little time in school to learn it all. What do you think should be included in the curriculum? Why?

Amy

I agree that traditional subjects like math, science, and reading are important, but so are classes in art and music. Engaging with art and music can help children be more creative and can stimulate their imaginations. That in turn facilitates critical thinking, which is essential in any curriculum, so I am in favor of including art and music in the school day.

Rory

Sure, drawing pictures and listening to music is fun, but children can do that on their own time. The school day is too short as it is. And there is so much foundational knowledge in math, reading, science, and history that children need to learn: it is better to spend classroom time on that foundational knowledge and let kids explore art and music at home.

2023.10.21 下午场

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

This week, we will be discussing space exploration. Some people think that it is a waste of money for governments to fund space exploration. Others disagree with this view arguing that space exploration is a valuable and necessary investment for our future. They think that it is worthy for governments to fund space exploration. I want to know what you think about this topic. Do you think that governments should fund space exploration? Why or why not?

Amy

I don't think that governments should fund space exploration because it will be too costly to build spaceships and develop related technologies. Though space exploration tech costs billions, it doesn't offer direct benefits to most people, which makes its funding a controversial issue.

Rory

Personally, I do think that all the costs will be worth it. The potential scientific discoveries and technological advancements could have far-reaching impacts that justify the initial investment. Imagine the new inventions that might come from this exploration. Such technology could greatly

improve our everyday lives.

10.22 线下考场考题 (11.09 号重复原题)

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words. An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

This week's course material will focus on scientific discoveries. While scientific researchers usually prefer to share what they learn with other scientists, many businesses and governments keep certain scientific discoveries secret. Some people believe that all scientific findings should be shared freely among scientists all around the world and that governments and businesses should not keep any discoveries secret. What do you believe and why?

Kelly:

I don't think all discoveries should be shared. Businesses, for example, often spend a lot of money on scientific research in order to make a discovery that can lead to profit. Even if that discovery benefits everyone, the business has a right to keep the discovery secret so that it can develop a profitable product from the research.

Andrew:

Sharing knowledge is crucially important to most scientists. Scientists usually publish the details of their discoveries in scientific journals, which means that everyone can see what the scientists have accomplished. Being recognized as the person who made a discovery is the biggest reward for any scientist. When scientists keep their discoveries secret, they lose that recognition. That is very unsatisfying.

2023.10.28

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

In today's rapidly changing world, the debate between urban and rural living has become increasingly relevant. While cities pulsate with energy, offering a myriad of cultural, educational, and professional opportunities, the countryside promises serenity, close ties with nature, and a different pace of life. Given the distinct characteristics and benefits of both settings, it brings us to the question: Do you prefer living in the countryside or the city?

Amy

I prefer living in the countryside because it's quieter. The village has less noise, which allows for a more peaceful and serene environment. It's a refreshing escape from the bustling sounds of urban areas.

Rory

I lean towards the countryside as well. The competitive pressure in the city is overwhelming. Living in the village offers a respite from the intense urban competition, providing a more relaxed and stress-free atmosphere.

2023.10.29

Your professor is teaching a class on economics. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

In today's discussion, we've covered how consumers these days are constantly bombarded with information from various channels that shape their preferences and decision making. Now let's look at a more specific example. When it comes to making purchasing decisions, individuals have access to a wide range of information sources. Many opt to seek guidance from their parents or close friends, valuing their insights and experiences. On the other hand, some individuals prefer to rely on internet suggestions to aid their choices. Which approach do you prefer? Why?

Amy

Seeking guidance from parents or close friends would probably be my first choice because they often have our best interests at heart and can offer insights based on their personal experiences. Their advice might be more tailored to our individual preferences and circumstances, and their recommendations may be more trustworthy since they know us well.

Rory

I would choose the second option because online reviews, recommendations, and product comparisons can provide a broader perspective on various options. This approach allows us to research extensively, read about other people's experiences, and potentially discover products or

solutions that we might not have considered otherwise.

2023.11.1

Your professor is teaching a class on business. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Today, we are going to discuss how successful software and tech products are launched and marketed. When companies launch and market these products, early adopters are important. Early adopters are customers who tend to buy the latest products and like to be the first to try out new features and processes. In today's discussion, I would like you to describe at least one advantage or disadvantage of being an early adopter. Please explain why you think this way.

Amy

One obvious disadvantage is that early adopters probably pay a lot more for brand-new technology. When products first come out, they're often quite expensive, but once they've been on the market for a while, the price usually drops. That's why I usually wait to buy new technology.

Rory

New tech products might not always be more expensive- sometimes the company will give people a new product at a discount in exchange for trying it out and giving feedback on it. In fact, to me, that's the biggest advantage of being an early adopter-your feedback can guide future improvements to a product. That's a powerful feeling.

2023.11.4

Your professor is teaching a class on environmental protection. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Considering environmental protection issues, do you think imposing taxes and fines on polluting companies is effective?

Amy

I don't think that method is necessarily effective. Some large or wealthy companies might choose to simply pay the fine rather than change their production methods or polluting behavior. They

might find paying the fine more economical than altering their production processes.

Rory

I have a different perspective. I believe that levying environmental taxes and fines on companies is effective. Firstly, taxes and fines can provide the government with funds that can be used for environmental protection projects or research into clean technologies. Secondly, even if some companies opt to pay the fines, many others will change their production methods to avoid these additional costs.

2023.11.11

Your professor is teaching a class on international relations. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

With so many opportunities to connect nowadays, some people believe that no matter which country we come from, we have more similarities than we have differences. However, others have observed that differences between themselves and people from other countries are growing. In your view, are differences between people from different countries increasing, or are they diminishing? Why?

Amy

I think the differences among us are decreasing as our exposure to products from other countries grows. We can enjoy food from any country. We can watch movies made in faraway places. We can go to a store and buy authentic goods from around the world. These things become part of our normal life and make our differences seem smaller.

Rory

I understand what Amy is saying, but for some people, being exposed to differences makes them retreat into their own corner even more. Look at social media. We are exposed to many different people and ideas, but a lot of people talk to only those they agree with and ignore the rest. This only makes the difference between people increase.

2023.11.12

Your professor is teaching a class on consumer behavior. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

We've been discussing the idea that human well-being is not necessarily improved by ever-increasing production and consumption of goods and services. Some people argue that humans already consume too many goods, from clothing to electronics to food; they believe that excessive consumption has created serious problems for humanity and even the planet. Do you agree that excessive consumption - buying more than we truly need - has become a serious problem? Why or why not?

Amy

I absolutely agree. We buy far more than we need, and that can't continue indefinitely. For years people have used shopping as a form of recreation. The products bought on a whim are filling up landfills, and the energy expended producing the goods has created a global warming crisis. We should start gradually reducing consumption.

Rory

I disagree with the idea that over-consumption is a dramatic problem. I agree there is some over-consumption, but it happens mostly with wealthy people. I think in general almost everyone else already buys only what they need. In fact, many people around the world are not even able to obtain everything they need.

2023.11.18

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Is using to-do lists an effective time management strategy?

Amy

I agree. Having a well-structured to-do list every day can be very effective. It helps in organizing tasks and ensuring that everything is completed in a timely manner. This method provides a clear roadmap for the day and enhances productivity.

Rory

I disagree. Every day brings about many different and interesting things. Rigidly sticking to a to-do list might hinder spontaneity and the ability to embrace unforeseen opportunities. Life's unpredictability can make it challenging to adhere strictly to a predetermined plan.

2023.11.22

Your professor is teaching a class on environmental protection. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

This week, we'll be discussing ways to address air pollution. One idea is introducing environmental taxes on air travel. Such taxes, also referred to as ecological taxes or green taxes, are extra charges that get added to the price of airplane tickets. Money collected from these taxes could be invested in environmentally friendly technologies or in promoting other cleaner modes of transportation. Do you think there should be an environmental tax on air travel? Why or why not?

Amy

We should impose environmental taxes on air travel. These taxes might encourage people to find cheaper, more eco-friendly ways to get places. In my country, many people use planes to fly a short distance because flights are relatively cheap, when they could just as easily take a less polluting form of transportation.

Rory

Additional taxes on air travel will do little to solve the problem of air pollution. Airplane tickets would become more expensive, punishing passengers without incentivizing airlines to become more environmentally friendly. The airlines should pay the price to protect the environment, not their customers.

2023.11.28

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Can children benefit from having pets?

Amy

Yes. Having pets can teach children a sense of responsibility and a caring attitude toward animals. They learn skills such as feeding on a schedule, cleaning cages, or walking the dog, which are valuable life skills. Additionally, spending time with pets may help children develop patience and empathy.

Rory

No, it ends up being the parents who take care of them. I know that often, children enthusiastically want to have a pet, but after a while, the responsibility of caring for the pet often shifts to the parents. Children may lose interest, and parents end up being responsible for the pet's care.

2023.12.3

Your professor is teaching a class on environmental protection. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

In today's world, the escalating environmental challenges demand collective efforts at the grassroots level. As local communities grapple with issues such as pollution, resource depletion, and habitat destruction, individuals play a pivotal role in initiating positive change. Given the urgency of the situation, the question arises: What is the most useful action for people to help the environment in their local communities?

Amy

I believe avoiding buying things that are not environmentally friendly is crucial. This includes being mindful of our purchases, opting for sustainable and eco-friendly products, and reducing overall consumption.

Rory

Planting trees and creating parks can have a significant impact. Trees contribute to cleaner air and provide habitats for various species, while parks offer green spaces for the community to enjoy and connect with nature.

2023.12.6

Your professor is teaching a class on environmental protection. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Charitable giving, which refers to the voluntary donation of money to charities, is important in many societies. Some individuals prefer donating to charities that provide assistance globally,

while others opt for local charities focusing on addressing issues within their own community. For those who wish to support only one type of charity, either international or local, which is the better choice? And why?

Amy

By donating to a local charity, such as a shelter that helps homeless animals, you can visit the shelter and see for yourself how donations are being used to confirm that your money is being well spent. You may even be encouraged to give more because you were able to witness the positive effects your contribution had on the organization.

Rory

It is more effective to donate money to international charities that work on issues that affect us all, such as the effects of climate change. Some charities that operate on a large scale have influenced national governments to adjust their air and water pollution policies, which is a great way to make a big impact.

2023.12.9

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

As urban areas grapple with increasing traffic congestion, the concept of congestion pricing has gained traction as a potential solution to alleviate gridlock and reduce environmental impact. This system involves charging drivers additional fees during peak hours, aiming to incentivize alternative transportation methods and mitigate traffic congestion. However, a contentious question arises: Is it good to impose congestion pricing on drivers during busy times?

Amy

I think it's a good idea to make drivers pay more during busy times. It can help reduce traffic and make people use other ways to get around, which is better for the environment.

Rory

I don't like the idea of making drivers pay extra during busy times. Some people might not have other ways to travel, and it could be too expensive for them. We should find a different solution that's fair for everyone.

2024.1.6

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Over the next few weeks, we'll begin discussing communication strategies in the workplace. These days there are many options for workplace communications. Sometimes people choose to communicate in writing through email or through messaging apps, while at other times they prefer talking to others face-to-face or by phone. What is the most important factor to consider when deciding whether to communicate in writing or by speaking in the workplace? Why?

Amy

I think privacy is the biggest factor in choosing to communicate in writing or speaking at work. If it's personal or confidential, it's better to email or message instead of talking out loud where everyone can hear. My dad always emails his boss private stuff rather than discussing it in the open office. Written communication lets you control who sees what you say.

Rory

I think the main factor in deciding to speak or write at work is how well you know someone. If you don't know a coworker that well, randomly showing up in their office to chat can interrupt their workflow. It's better to email new coworkers at first until you build more of a rapport. Once you're more familiar with each other, face-to-face talks are easier and less disruptive.

2024.1.13

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Having students work together in small groups on learning activities is a popular alternative to teaching the whole class as one large group. The average age of students in a classroom can, of course, be an important consideration when choosing any teaching approach. I'd like us to consider two age groups: very young students (ages 5-11) and older students (ages 14-18). Which age group do you think would benefit more from working in small groups on learning activities? Why?

Amy

I think young elementary school kids would benefit more from small group activities than high schoolers. Young kids are often more eager to participate and cooperate, whereas teens can be disengaged and distracted during class. Grouping kids when they're young can teach them social skills and get them excited about learning together. High schoolers may prefer independent work where they can focus without distractions from peers.

Rory

I think older high school students would benefit more from small group work. Teens tend to be more competitive and motivated to stand out, so working in groups can encourage them to challenge each other intellectually. From my experience in group projects for class, we pushed each other to think deeper and produce better work than we could have individually.

2024.1.20

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

As teachers play an invaluable role in shaping young minds and preparing students for the future, there is an ongoing discussion regarding their compensation. Some argue that teachers should be paid salaries comparable to other high-earning professionals like doctors, lawyers and business executives. Do you agree or disagree that teachers deserve salaries on par with these professions? Please explain your viewpoint.

Amy

Teachers should receive salaries on par with other high-earning professionals. They work long hours preparing lessons, grading assignments, and supporting students. Without good teachers, we wouldn't have doctors, lawyers, and executives. If we want to attract the best talent to this invaluable profession, we must compensate teachers accordingly. My favorite teachers inspired me and contributed greatly to my success.

Rory

I don't think teachers deserve the same high salaries as doctors or lawyers. Teachers get so much time off, with summer vacations and other long breaks. My aunt is a teacher and she's always posting on Facebook about trips she takes or sleeping in during vacations. With all that time off, teachers shouldn't earn salaries on par with year-round demanding professions.

2024.1.24

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

This week, we discussed the importance of role models in society. One idea we discussed was the widespread impact of "influencers". Influencers are people who are very active posting on social media and who have many followers. Influencers' posts and opinions can influence their followers' choices on everything from fashion to politics. In your opinion, do social media influencers generally have a positive or negative effect on their followers? Why do you think so?

Amy

I think the influencers' effect is generally positive. People can learn about the latest trends and topics in a very quick and efficient way by following influencers. In the past, people had to spend time looking through magazines or visiting boutiques to even know what was trending.

Rory

I think influencers generally have a negative effect because they have far too much influence. I can think of one influencer who only has to mention a particular kind of sports shoes, and the next day they'll be sold out. The followers aren't really thinking for themselves; they're just blindly following their influencers' choices.

2024.1.27

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

College tuition has been rising steadily, putting financial pressure on many families. One proposal is that government should cover tuition costs so that anyone can attend college for free. What do you think? Should government pay for college and make higher education free? Please explain your viewpoint.

Amy

I believe college should be free for all students. This would promote fairness and access to education, giving underprivileged students more opportunities. Everyone deserves a chance to

pursue higher education, regardless of their financial situation. Free tuition would open doors for many capable students who currently can't afford the high costs of attending college.

Rory

I don't think college should be free for all. That could attract many students who aren't genuinely interested in learning, overcrowding classes. It's better to keep some cost so students are motivated and classes aren't too large, which hurts the quality of education.

2024.2.3 上午场

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

One traditional method of classroom instruction is lecturing. Lecturing involves the teacher talking about a topic for an extended period of time and expecting students to learn by listening attentively. Today, some educators believe that teachers should limit how much time they spend lecturing and instead teach by encouraging in-class discussions and having students work in groups. However, some teachers still teach primarily by lecturing. Do you believe lecturing is an effective teaching method? Why or why not?

Amy

I believe lecturing can be an extremely effective way for professors to teach if they have strong communication skills. Some of my most memorable classes have been taught by brilliant lecturers who captivated me with their engaging speaking style, ability to explain complex topics clearly, and passion for their subject matter.

Rory

I don't think pure lecturing works well as a teaching method. Without student participation, professors have no way to assess if students actually comprehend the material. Students can easily zone out during long lectures if they are just passively listening. Active learning through discussions, activities, and questions lets students engage with content and teachers identify gaps in understanding.

2024.2.18

Your professor is teaching a class on marketing. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Let's continue talking about consumer behavior. We have been discussing different ways people go about choosing what products to buy, and there are many potential sources of information and advice for consumers. In your opinion, which is the better strategy for making purchasing decisions, relying on advice from friends and family, or depending on information from online sources? Why?

Amy

Seeking guidance from parents or close friends would probably be my first choice because they often have our best interests at heart and can offer insights based on their personal experiences. Their advice might be more tailored to our individual preferences and circumstances, and their recommendations may be more trustworthy since they know us well.

Rory

I would choose the second option because online reviews, recommendations, and product comparisons can provide a broader perspective on various options. This approach allows us to research extensively, read about other people's experiences, and potentially discover products or solutions that we might not have considered otherwise.

2024.2.27

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

This week we talked about how important taking time off from work or school is for people's well-being. Some people believe they get the most benefit when that time off is structured: that is, it involves planning in advance about what will be accomplished on that day. Others believe it is better to enjoy the day with no plan for how to spend it. In this discussion post please indicate which of those approaches to spending time off from work or school you prefer and why?

Amy

I find it beneficial to do some advance planning for my free time. I live far away from my family so when I am getting ready to visit them during a school holiday, I always plan my time off from school very carefully. That way I have enough time to visit with each family member.

Rory

Personally, I prefer not to make any plans for my free time. I go to school, and I have a part-time job each week. I make a schedule to be sure I can complete both my work and my studies. So when I have time off from work and school, I just want to relax with no plan.

2024.3.2

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

This week we will discuss issues faced by secondary school administrators. I'm referring to schools for teenage students. One such issue is students who change schools. Students change schools for many different reasons, the most common being a family move. On the discussion board, I want you to exchange ideas about what schools can do to make the transition to a new school easier for teenagers.

Amy

I think schools should assign new students a fellow student who can help them adjust. The "student buddy" can do things like make sure the new student can find the cafeteria or the right classrooms. For new students, it's a lot easier to ask a fellow student a question rather than ask a teacher or the principal.

Rory

I would require new students to sign up for some school club or activity that meets outside of class. That way, new students would have an easy way to meet other students in a friendly environment. It would give them a group to immediately identify with.

2024.3.6

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

This week, we'll examine issues in education reform. For example, some educators think that by focusing mainly on foundational knowledge in subjects like reading, math, and science, schools are not fully preparing students for success in the workplace. These educators argue that soft

skills-nonacademic skills such as being empathetic or having a strong work ethic-should be part of the curriculum, with classroom time dedicated to developing these skills. Do you agree? Why or why not?

Amy

I agree. While students need a strong foundation in academic subjects, soft skills are important because they affect how well students do their work. If classroom time is set aside for these skills, students will take them seriously and their academic work will benefit. Teachers could design lessons so that students learn about a skill and then do role-playing activities with classmates.

Rory

Soft skills are important, but I don't agree with using classroom time to work on them. I'm not sure how teachers would measure students' progress in developing these skills. If students' progress can't be measured on something taught, I'm not sure if there's any point to teaching.

2024.3.10

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Next week we'll be talking about factors that contribute to human happiness. Surveys reveal that career satisfaction and the quality of personal relationships, such as with family and friends, are frequently identified as two important factors for happiness. Which of these two factors -career or relationships do you think most people would say has the greater impact on their overall happiness, and why?

Amy

I would say career satisfaction impacts overall happiness more. Having a fulfilling job gives you a sense of purpose and achievement that's hard to replicate elsewhere. It's a core part of your identity and self-worth. Relationships are vital too, but work dominates so much of our waking lives that its role in our well-being can't be overstated.

Rory

Relationships are more impactful for happiness than career. We're social beings, so having strong bonds with family and friends fulfills a core need. Quality time with loved ones boosts positive emotions and provides a support system during tough times. That's why relationships trump career when it comes to overall well-being.

2024.3.12

Your professor is teaching a class on government policy. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

We've been discussing government budgets and the difficult decisions governments must make regarding the use of public funds. Some services are clearly essential and must be paid for by any government. But what about public funding of the arts? Do you believe that governments should provide financial support for artists- for example, painters, sculptors, musicians, or filmmakers? Why or why not?

Amy

I enjoy art as much as anyone does, but public funds come from taxes, and I don't think taxpayers' hard-earned money should be spent on impractical or inessential items and services. Artists should support themselves by selling their work to private individual and companies. If they can't find enough buyers, then maybe they should change careers.

Rory

Personally I think art actually is essential. Lots of public spaces in my hometown just wouldn't be the same without artwork. From statues in public parks to murals painted on the walls of government buildings, my hometown really benefits from funding the artists who created these works. The public spaces are simply more enjoyable for visitors because of the artwork.

2024.3.16

Your professor is teaching a class on public policies. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

In recent years, there has been ongoing debate regarding the relevance and necessity of public libraries. Some argue that in the digital age, where information is readily available online, libraries may have lost their significance. What are your thoughts on the importance of libraries today? Do you believe cities should continue to maintain public libraries?

Amy

Libraries were relevant when books were the main source of knowledge and people couldn't afford personal libraries. But in our digital world, public funding for libraries is an unnecessary

expenditure. With so much information online, who needs physical books? Very few people read anymore. I haven't stepped foot in a library for years.

Rory

Public libraries are still valuable community resources. While digital information is widespread, libraries offer engaging programs that inspire kids' love of reading. From storytimes to summer reading clubs, these activities get children excited about books in a way websites can't match. Libraries nurture the next generation of readers - we shouldn't abandon them yet.

2024.3.23

Your professor is teaching a class on entrepreneurship. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

This week, we'll be exploring the dynamics of entrepreneurship, particularly focusing on whether entrepreneurs should collaborate with family members when starting a business or if it's preferable to avoid such partnerships. Many entrepreneurs face this dilemma due to the potential benefits of trust and shared vision with family, but also the risks of conflicts and business complications. What are your thoughts on this? Do you believe it's best for entrepreneurs to start a business with family members?

Amy

I don't think it's a good idea for entrepreneurs to go into business with family members. While you may have trust and share the same vision, family members tend to think too much alike. This limits new perspectives and innovation. There's also a higher risk of conflicts and messy situations arising between relatives that could hurt the business.

Rory

Working together with family members can really strengthen the family bond and shared goals. My uncle and cousins started a restaurant, and seeing them collaborate with that level of trust and commitment is inspiring. Though conflicts may arise, if you can resolve them, it'll make the family ties even stronger in the end.

2024.3.27

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

People travel for many reasons. Traveling allows people to practice a different language, explore and admire new landscapes, and encounter other cultures. In the past, physical travel was the only practical way to experience the pleasures and benefits of traveling. Today, television and the Internet allow people to experience many aspects of distant places without leaving their homes. Do you believe that exploring other places through technology offers many of the same benefits as in-person travel? Why or why not?

Amy

Absolutely, virtual travel offers many benefits of physical travel. Through the internet and TV, we can immerse ourselves in the sceneries, different cultures, and even pick up languages—all from home. It's eco-friendly, cost-effective, and allows us to better prepare for an actual trip.

Rory

I don't believe exploring places through technology offers the same benefits as in-person travel. While virtual tours and online content give us a glimpse into different cultures, they fail to fully capture the sights, smells, sounds and feel of being there physically. It's only a shallow substitute for the real thing.

2024.4.6

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

This week, we will be discussing space exploration. Some people think that it is a waste of money for governments to fund space exploration. Others disagree with this view arguing that space exploration is a valuable and necessary investment for our future. They think that it is worthy for governments to fund space exploration. I want to know what you think about this topic. Do you think that governments should fund space exploration? Why or why not?

Amy

I don't think that governments should fund space exploration because it will be too costly to build spaceships and develop related technologies. Though space exploration tech costs billions, it doesn't offer direct benefits to most people, which makes its funding a controversial issue.

Rory

Personally, I do think that all the costs will be worth it. The potential scientific discoveries and

technological advancements could have far-reaching impacts that justify the initial investment. Imagine the new inventions that might come from this exploration. Such technology could greatly improve our everyday lives.

2024.4.13

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

Some argue that factories, as major producers of pollution and waste, should be pushed to make dramatic changes in how they operate in order to protect and preserve the environment. Others contend that it is the small, cumulative actions of individuals that lead to the greatest impact, so public awareness and altered societal norms are most critical. I would like you to consider: who do you believe should make more efforts when it comes to environmental protection - factories or individuals?

Amy

Factories should take the lead on protecting the environment because their impact is massive compared to individuals. For example, a single factory can generate tons of pollution per day, dwarfing what one person produces in a lifetime. Strict regulations and greener technologies for manufacturers would lead to huge reductions in emissions and waste.

Rory

Individuals should lead on environmental protection because we can drive cultural change. By making green lifestyle choices - reducing energy, taking public transit, minimizing waste - we set an example and normalize sustainability. And by purchasing eco-products and ethical companies, everyday consumer decisions incentivize businesses to follow suit.

2024.4.17

Your professor is teaching a class on business. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Smith

We've been discussing business strategies and the attitudes of business people toward risk and opportunity. The scientist Albert Einstein once said that a person who never made a mistake never

tried anything new. He was probably referring to physics, but I wonder how this attitude might apply to the business world. Do you think it is a good business strategy to take continual risks even though they might result in mistakes that could affect a company negatively?

Amy

I think this strategy can easily backfire on a businessperson. I've seen companies conduct endless cycles of product enhancements in an effort to capture some other market share. But in reality, they just damage their own brand by sacrificing too much of the original content that made the product popular in the first place.

Rory

I disagree with Amy. Most profitable businesses have used this strategy or they would have never made it to the top. If you plan to grow a business aggressively, some mistakes along the way are inevitable. Too much caution or too much emphasis on avoiding mistakes can really prevent growth.

2024.4.21

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

Last week, we started talking about decisions that university administrators have to make regarding spending. They often need to decide how to allocate their funds, including renovating existing facilities, offering new amenities, and so on. For example, a university could spend money to upgrade a sports stadium, build a new performing arts center, or do a variety of other things. What is the most important thing university administrators should consider when making decisions regarding spending?

Paul:

I believe university administrators should prioritize students' opinions when deciding on spending. After all, students are the main source of the school's income. For instance, if the university wants to upgrade sports facilities but students are more interested in a new library or tech center, it makes sense to let students vote on it.

Claire:

University administrators should prioritize projects that can generate future revenue. For example, investing in a [state-of-the-art](#) research facility or tech incubator could attract more students and partnerships, leading to increased funding and grants. It's essential to consider not just the immediate benefits but also the long-term financial sustainability for the university.

2024.4.24

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

In our upcoming lesson, we will explore the evolution of public health and its impact on the well-being of individuals. Considering the significant progress we've made in healthcare and nutrition, as well as the ongoing challenges such as sedentary lifestyles and stress, I'd like you to reflect on the following question: Do you believe that people are generally healthier now than they were in the past? Why or why not?

Paul:

I believe that people are generally healthier today than they were in the past, and the advancements in medical care play a significant role in longer life expectancy. With the development of new drugs and treatments, we're able to combat illnesses that were once fatal, such as various forms of cancer and heart diseases.

Claire:

While it's true that we've made incredible strides in healthcare and nutrition, the lifestyle-related health issues we face today were less common in the past. It's not just about medical

advancements; it's about how we live our lives day to day. The quality of life is being compromised by our poor eating and exercise habits.

2024.5.11

Your professor is teaching a class on entrepreneurship. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

In recent corporate strategies, we've observed a trend where companies are offering to pay for their employees' tuition fees or providing additional vacation time in exchange for the employees enrolling in further skills training courses, such as university programs. This approach is seen as a way to enhance the workforce's capabilities and foster a culture of continuous learning. What do you perceive as the most significant advantage or disadvantage of such a policy?

Andrew

In my view, the downside of companies paying for employees' further education is that it could lead to increased turnover. If workers gain new skills, they might feel empowered to seek better opportunities elsewhere. I've heard of cases where employees, after getting their degrees, decide to leave for more competitive roles or higher pay, which can be a significant loss for the company that invested in their education.

Claire

I see a different angle on this policy of companies funding employee education. When a company invests in an employee's future, it sends a powerful message of value and sincerity. It's like they're saying, 'We believe in you and your growth.' For me, that kind of commitment would make me feel more dedicated to the company.

2024.5.15

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

Many areas are trying to reduce fossil fuel consumption because such fuel causes pollution and may contribute to climate change. To this end, some local governments want to find ways to encourage more people to use electric vehicles. In preparation for a class discussion on this issue, please post a response indicating what policy or initiative you would recommend that governments implement to encourage more use of electric vehicles, please explain why you think so.

Kelly

I live in an apartment building and would have difficulty charging an electric vehicle at home. I think that governments should offer financial support to encourage places such as shopping districts to install a large number of charging stations, maybe even free ones, that the public could use.

Paul

People in my city often deal with long commutes in heavy traffic. But if my local government could set aside lanes on the high-traffic roadways that only electric cars could use, that might encourage people to purchase such a vehicle because they would have shorter and easier commutes.

2024.5.18

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

Recently, the town has decided to revoke the mandatory helmet-wearing rule for cyclists. This decision has sparked debate among residents. Some argue that it promotes freedom and convenience, while others express concerns about safety. Considering this, do you believe suburban governments should respond to citizens' demands to remove helmet regulations for cyclists? Why or why not?

Andrew:

I support the removal of helmet regulations for cyclists. Wearing a helmet is cumbersome and inconvenient, discouraging people from cycling altogether. Removing this requirement would likely encourage more people to choose cycling as a mode of transportation, promoting healthier and more environmentally friendly lifestyles.

Claire:

People should consider the implications of this policy. It's important to adhere to government regulations for safety reasons. Helmet laws are in place to protect cyclists from head injuries in case of accidents. So, even though some may view the removal of helmet regulations as promoting freedom, helmets keep you safe.

2024.5.26

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe:

In recent years, there has been a significant integration of advanced machines and artificial intelligence (AI) into our daily lives and work environments. I would like you to reflect on the following question: Should we extend the same level of politeness and respect to AI and machines

as we do to humans? Please provide your reasoning and discuss the potential consequences of adopting such an approach.

Andrew:

AI and robots play an integral role in our lives, assisting us in various tasks and making our lives easier. By treating them with respect, we not only acknowledge their contributions but also reflect positively on our own character. It's a small gesture that upholds our humanity and sets a standard for ethical interaction with technology.

Claire:

I think we don't need to treat AI and robots with the same politeness as we do humans. They are tools designed to assist us, and it's important to maintain that distinction. We should set clear guidelines and boundaries for their use to ensure they serve us effectively without overstepping their roles.

2024.6.2

Your professor is teaching a class on business. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Dr. Achebe

We have been discussing employee working arrangements -whether employees should report to an office or work at home. Some businesses require all employees to work in the office. Others choose not to have a physical office and have all employees work from home. In industries where remote work is possible, what is the most important factor for employers to consider when deciding where employees should work and why?

Clare:

I don't think businesses should allow their employees to work from home, because creating a sense of community and camaraderie among employees is so important for the success of a business, especially if it is a small business. It is challenging to develop that dynamic when employees are not together physically in the same space.

Andrew:

I think the most important thing to consider is the bottom line: keeping company expenses down. For example, requiring all employees to work from home might be the best option from an economic standpoint. Renting office space is expensive, as are the utility bills. Think of how much money a business could save if employees worked from home.

2024.6.8

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor-Achebe:

In our next session, we will be discussing the topic of workplace communication. Some believe that daily communication with the supervisor is more beneficial for employee growth and problem resolution, while others advocate for less frequent communication with the supervisor to maintain focus and efficiency. Which approach do you think is more beneficial for employees? Please discuss your preference and explain the reasons behind your choice.

Claire:

I believe frequent communication with a supervisor is more beneficial for employees. It allows the supervisor to understand your direction and make timely adjustments if needed. For Instance, if you're working on a project and encounter an issue, regular check-ins mean you can quickly get advice and avoid going off track. This helps in achieving goals more efficiently.

Paul:

I think less frequent communication with a supervisor is better. Daily feedback can sometimes hurt your confidence, especially if it's negative. For example, if you're constantly being corrected, you might start doubting your abilities. With less frequent check-ins, you have more time to focus on your work and build your skills without feeling pressured or criticized all the time.

2024.6.12

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor-Achebe:

Many areas are trying to reduce fossil fuel consumption because such fuel causes pollution and may contribute to climate change. To this end, some local governments want to find ways to encourage more people to use electric vehicles. In preparation for a class discussion on this issue, please post a response indicating what policy or initiative you would recommend that governments implement to encourage more use of electric vehicles, please explain why you think so.

Kelly:

I live in an apartment building and would have difficulty charging an electric vehicle at home. I think that governments should offer financial support to encourage places such as shopping districts to install a large number of charging stations, maybe even free ones, that the public could use.

Paul:

People in my city often deal with long commutes in heavy traffic. But if my local government could set aside lanes on the high-traffic roadways that only electric cars could use, that might encourage people to purchase such a vehicle because they would have shorter and easier commutes.

2024.6.16

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor-Achebe:

This week, we are discussing the social psychology of sports. We have learned that sports often have positive psychological effects on athletes, such as the members of sports teams. But how can we describe their effects on other groups of people, such as sports enthusiasts or sports fans? Consider the following question: when people spend a lot of time watching sports or following their favorite team, does it have a negative effect on their lives? Why or why not?

Claire:

I agree that focusing on sports too much can have negative impacts. For example, some people who like watching sports on television have few other interests. In fact, it seems like watching sports is all they're interested in. I sometimes find such people annoying because they care too much about things that don't matter.

Paul:

I am not sure what we mean by spending "a lot of time" following sports. But following sports has helped me in life when I first met one of my best friends, Daphne, I started a conversation with her by saying something about a sports team I liked. Then we moved to other topics. But sports were a great conversation starter.

2024.6.22

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

Today, we will be discussing a company's hiring strategies. When hiring new employees, recruiters usually review resumes to learn about candidates. However, with social media becoming popular, some companies are trying new ways to find out more about candidates. Recruiters view what candidates post on social media, like Twitter, to see their personality and skills. This helps to see if they match with the company's culture and job requirements. Do you believe that checking a

candidate's social media is a fair and effective way to evaluate if someone is right for the company? Why or why not?

Andrew

This approach is fresh and interesting, but it has its drawbacks. Some candidates are super active on social media, while others rarely share anything. So, just looking at their online profiles might not give recruiters the whole story of what they're really like.

Claire

I don't think this is a great idea. What people share on their personal social media might not be related to their professional abilities or work ethics. Things like photos they've posted or comments they've made don't really help recruiters judge if they're suitable for the company.

2024.6.26

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

Some educators think that in our global, tech-oriented world, students need to focus on nonfiction texts, such as news stories, technical manuals, or other informational materials. They say that reading poetry, novels, and short stories is not the optimal use of the limited time that students have in the classroom. How do you view this approach to education? Should schools limit the teaching of fictional texts in favor of teaching more practical, nonfiction texts?

Andrew

Education has to evolve. Nowadays there's an enormous amount of economic and political data freely available online. It's important that students can evaluate this information to understand local and world events in order to be good citizens. Reading fiction is a wonderful hobby but school should prepare students for adult life and its responsibilities.

Claire

I spent a lot of class time in high school analyzing literature. I'm studying to be an engineer, so I admit that reading fiction in school was not directly applicable to my future occupation, but it did instill in me a love of reading, which is very valuable. I feel better equipped now to understand all sorts of written material.

2024.6.30

Your professor is teaching a class on health and nutrition. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

To continue our discussion of the health benefits of good nutrition, I'd like you to consider the broader topic of eating habits--not just what people eat and drink, but how often, how much, and when. Those who want to improve their health often begin by changing some kind of eating habit. This includes a wide range of behavior. What is one poor eating habit that would be important for most people to change, and why?

Andrew

I think most people don't bother to learn much about the food that they eat. This ignorance is a kind of bad eating habit. It can be burdensome, but you should try to read every food package label. The more you can learn about what you're putting in your body, the more likely you'll be to make good decisions.

Claire

If people could start with one change to improve their eating habits, it would be to eat a better breakfast. Most people are so rushed in the morning that they don't take the time to sit down and eat a balanced meal. A good breakfast gives you more energy all day and keeps you from eating too much later on.

2024.7.10

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

While owning lots of consumer products is believed to increase the quality of life, these products can also impose responsibilities on those who own them. For example, electronic devices, appliances, and vehicles require constant attention and regular maintenance. Possessions also need to be stored and organized, taking up time and space. For these reasons, some people argue that having many possessions can actually decrease the quality of life. Do you agree or disagree? Why?

Andrew

I totally agree that an excess of possessions can drag down our quality of life. Just think about the time we spend organizing closets or garages. I spend hours every month sorting and storing clothes in my closet. This clutter and the time it takes to manage it can become overwhelming and detract from enjoying life.

Claire

Just the thought of having to constantly worry about my gadgets, or even my car, needing maintenance gives me anxiety. It's like adding extra homework to life. Life often requires owning many things, but personally, I hate having to take care of them all or worry about them getting damaged or lost.

2024.7.21

Your professor is teaching a class on business. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.

- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

This week, we are going to discuss companies' policies for promotion. Companies tend to value different things and set different criteria for determining who deserves a promotion. Criteria for promotion may include employees performance and achievements in their current roles, seniority within the company, years of experience in the field, or even leadership potential. In today's post, I would like you to discuss which criteria for promotion you see as the most important and explain why.

Andrew

I believe seniority should be the most important criterion for promotion. Rewarding employees who have been with the company for a long time shows that the company values loyalty and dedication. Long-term employees often have a deep understanding of the company's culture and processes, which can be invaluable.

Claire

I think job performance should be the top criterion for promotions. Rewarding employees for their skills and achievements pushes them to excel in their roles. When people see that their hard work and dedication are recognized, they're motivated to take the next step in their careers.

2024.7.24

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

In your response, you should do the following.

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor Achebe:

In recent years, there has been a noticeable shift in the choices travelers make for their accommodations. Many are now opting for privately owned residences over traditional hotels. This change is reshaping the travel industry and creating a competitive landscape between these

two types of lodging. Do you think the increased competition between privately owned residences and traditional hotels is a positive trend? Why or why not?

Andrew

Yes, it benefits homeowners by providing them with an additional income stream. For travelers, it often means more affordable accommodation options. For instance, during my last vacation. I chose a privately owned residence and saved a significant amount compared to hotel prices. This trend enhances travel experiences while supporting local economies.

Claire

No, I don't think it's a positive trend. Staying in hotels offers more opportunities to meet new people and socialize. I stayed at a hotel last year and met other travelers during breakfast and in common areas. This aspect of hotel stays can enhance the travel experience by fostering new connections

2024.8.17

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor-Achebe:

Long school breaks offer students a valuable opportunity to reset and recharge. However, some educators believe that schools should assign work during these breaks to help students stay engaged with their studies and retain knowledge. What do you think? Should schools assign homework during long school breaks?

Kelly:

I think schools should assign some homework during long breaks, but it should be work that interests students and isn't boring. This way, students can stay engaged and reinforce what they've learned without feeling overwhelmed. This keeps learning fun while still helping them retain important knowledge during the break.

Paul:

I don't think schools should assign homework during long breaks because if students run into problems, they won't have access to teachers for help. If a student is struggling with a math problem and has no one to explain it, they might waste a lot of time without learning anything.

2024.8.21

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Doctor-Achebe:

Online shopping is becoming the primary way that many people obtain everyday goods. But what are the ramifications for the society in which we live? On the one hand, online shopping has advantages—for example, I can make a purchase without ever leaving my home. However, with fewer people shopping at local shops, in some places, these establishments are having a hard time competing. How, do you think, online shopping is, on the whole, affecting society?

Kelly:

I think that online shopping has had negative impacts on society. In my city, many local stores have shelves filled with various products that you can find in online stores. This has forced some of them to close down, which not only affects the amount of tax revenue generated in our local community but also impacts the number of job opportunities available to the community.

Paul:

It's unfortunate that some local stores are forced to close down, but that's the nature of competition. As consumers, we benefit greatly from online shopping due to lower prices. Even if I find a physical store that can compete with online sellers in terms of pricing, I am still likely to make the purchase online because it means I don't have to spend money on transportation to the store.

2024.8.24

Your professor is teaching a class on business. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

We've been talking about the process of starting a new business. One of the most important aspects of the process is staffing that is, deciding which people to hire. Please discuss the following question: is it better for new businesses to hire experienced veterans of the industry or to staff the business with younger employees who are right out of university? Why do you think so?

Claire:

I think a company should staff a business with the most experienced employees possible. If you're starting a new business, you need people around you who know what they are doing and can quickly get the business up to speed. Spending time training inexperienced people will slow you down.

Paul:

I understand what Claire is saying, but if you are starting a new business, you want people who are particularly enthusiastic and energetic. Who better than a recent graduate to bring those qualities to the job? You would be guaranteed an ambitious hard worker.

2024.8.26

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Today, we will discuss a topic that is important for students and the public at large: namely, how to prioritize spending, given the limited funding available for schools. Some people think schools should spend more money on school teachers's salaries because it would attract more qualified individuals to the profession. On the other hand, others believe that the money should be allocated towards additional resources such as books and computers. Which viewpoint do you agree with and why?

Kelly:

I believe that increasing teachers' salaries will improve the quality of education, they earn more money, people will consider teaching as a viable profession rather than opting for private sector jobs. We need the brightest minds in the classrooms.

Paul:

I acknowledge that schoolteachers already earn a decent salary and provide high-quality education. I'm not certain how much of an impact increasing their salaries would have • Nonetheless, schools always require new equipment or facilities • Knowledge and technology are constantly evolving, and we need to prepare students with the most up-to-date materials possible.

2024.8.28

Your professor is teaching a class on entrepreneurship. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

This week, we'll be exploring the dynamics of entrepreneurship, particularly focusing on whether entrepreneurs should collaborate with family members when starting a business or if it's preferable to avoid such partnerships. Many entrepreneurs face this dilemma due to the potential benefits of trust and shared vision with family, but also the risks of conflicts and business complications. What are your thoughts on this? Do you believe it's best for entrepreneurs to start a business with family members?

Claire:

I don't think it's a good idea for entrepreneurs to go into business with family members. While you may have trust and share the same vision, family members tend to think too much alike. This limits new perspectives and innovation. There's also a higher risk of conflicts and messy situations arising between relatives that could hurt the business.

Paul:

Working together with family members can really strengthen the family bond and shared goals. My uncle and cousins started a restaurant, and seeing them collaborate with that level of trust and

commitment is inspiring. Though conflicts may arise, if you can resolve them • it'll make the family ties even stronger in the end.

2024.9.1

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

This week, we will be discussing ways to address air pollution. One idea is introducing environmental taxes on air travel. Such taxes, also referred to as ecological taxes or green taxes, are extra charges that get added to the price of airplane tickets. Money collected from these taxes could be invested in environmentally friendly technologies and promoting other, cleaner modes of transportation. Do you think there should be an environmental tax on air travel?

Kelly:

We should impose environmental taxes on air travel. These taxes might encourage people to find cheaper, more eco-friendly ways to get places. In my country, many people use planes to fly a short distance because flights are relatively cheap when they could just as easily take a less polluting form of transportation.

Andrew:

Additional taxes on air travel will do little to solve the problem of air pollution. Airplane tickets would become more expensive, punishing passengers without incentivizing airlines to become more environmentally friendly. The airlines should pay the price to protect the environment, not their customers.

2024.9.4

Your professor is teaching a class on public policy. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

We have read studies that explain the negative impact of social media on both children and adults. Many believe that social media will remain widely used in the future, since it is both popular and useful in some contexts, but because of the problems it poses, it should be regulated in some way. In your opinion, should governments regulate social media platforms, or should social media companies regulate their platforms themselves? Why do you think so?

Andrew:

I believe social media companies should regulate themselves. There are plenty of social media platforms on the market, so the competition is tough. For example, to appeal to parents, a social media platform could publicize that they have stringent regulations for children's use of the platform, and in this way it could attract more users who care about children's safety.

Claire:

Social media companies should be taking an active role in combatting the negative effects, but that is not really happening. I hear many stories of false information spreading around, sometimes causing irreparable damage to people's reputations. Therefore the government should put stricter regulations on the companies, and they should be punished for not following the rules.

2024.9.8

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Today, we will discuss a topic that is important for students and the public at large: namely, how to prioritize spending, given the limited funding available for schools. Some people think schools should spend more money on school teachers' salaries because it would attract more qualified individuals to the profession. On the other hand, others believe that the money should be allocated towards additional resources such as books and computers. Which viewpoint do you agree with and why?

Kelly:

I believe that increasing teachers's salaries will improve the quality of education. If they earn more money, people will consider teaching as a viable profession rather than opting for private sector jobs. We need the brightest minds in the classrooms.

Paul:

I acknowledge that schoolteachers already earn a decent salary and provide high-quality education. I'm not certain how much of an impact in creasing their salaries would have. Nonetheless, schools always require new equipment or facilities. Knowledge and technology are constantly evolving, and we need to prepare students with the most up-to date materials possible.

2024.9.14

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

In recent years, there has been a decline in the popularity of classical music particularly among young adults (18-25). Classical music now often competes with more contemporary genres for attention. What do you think is the most effective way to reignite an interest in classical music among younger generations? Please provide reasons for your answer.

Claire:

One way to get young adults interested in classical music is through more media coverage •

Newspapers, TV shows, and online platforms could highlight classical music events, feature popular musicians or discuss its cultural significance. This would raise awareness and make classical music more visible.

Paul:

I think we can hold concerts in public places like shopping malls. These events would expose people to classical music in a casual, everyday setting. Someone walking by might stop to listen, and it could spark their interest. By bringing classical music directly to the public, we can make it more accessible and engaging for younger audiences.

2024.9.15

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

This week, we will discuss different approaches to teaching children financial responsibility. Some parents give their children a weekly allowance to help them learn money management, while others believe it has no real benefit and may lead to bad habits. Which approach do you think is better for a child's development, and why? Please explain your reasoning.

Kelly:

I believe children should receive an allowance because it helps them put their math skills to use. By managing their own money, they learn how to budget, save, and make spending decisions. For example, if they want to buy something expensive, they have to figure out how long it will take to save enough money.

Andrew:

I'm against giving children an allowance because it can create conflict within families. For instance, if a child learns their friends receive more money, it could lead to resentment or arguments at home. Rather than fostering financial responsibility, it might cause unnecessary friction.

2024.9.21

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

In today's world, we have various ways to stay informed about current events. Traditional sources like television and newspapers have long been trusted by many, providing detailed and well-researched news. However, with the rise of social media, an increasing number of people are

turning to these platforms for quick and accessible updates. Which do you think is a better source of news; traditional outlets like television and newspapers, or social media?

Claire:

I believe social media is a better source of news because it provides quick updates. For example, during breaking news events, social media platforms often deliver information faster than traditional outlets like newspapers or television. This immediate access allows people to stay informed in real-time.

Paul:

I think traditional news sources are better because they tend to be more accurate. Television, for instance, not only provides well-researched reports but also offers visuals that help viewers understand the story better. Social media might be faster, but it often lacks the depth and verification traditional sources provide.

2024.9.22

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

We've been discussing government budgets and the difficult decisions governments must make regarding the use of public funds. Some services are clearly essential and must be paid for by any government. But what about public funding of the arts? Do you believe that governments should provide financial support to artists, for example, painters, sculptures, musicians, or filmmakers? Why or why not?

Claire:

I enjoy art as much as anyone does, but public funds come from taxes, and I don't think taxpayers' hard-earned money should be spent on impractical or inessential items and services. Artists should support themselves by selling their work to private individuals and companies. If they cannot find enough buyers, then maybe they should change careers.

Paul:

Personally, I think art actually is essential. Lots of public spaces in my hometown just wouldn't be the same without artwork. From statues in public parks to murals painted on the walls of government buildings, my hometown really benefits from funding the artists who created these works. The public spaces are simply more enjoyable for visitors because of the artwork.

2024.10.12

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

This week, we'll look at how different people view friendships and relationships focusing on the number of friends. People often debate whether it's better to maintain friendships with a small group of people or expand one's social circle. Some believe in developing deeper, closer relationships with a select few. On the other hand, others believe it's more important to increase the number of friends. Which view do you agree with? Why?

Claire:

I believe that having many friends is better. Some people find having deep conversations difficult because they are not comfortable sharing personal thoughts face to face. Social media can help these people make friends more easily. With many friends, we can gain different perspectives and broaden our understanding.

Andrew:

For me, having a small group of close friends is better. These close friends, who know us deeply, are our go-to people when we seek help. They stand by us in challenging times providing support and helping us overcome problems due to their understanding of our lives. This is the unique benefit of close friendships.

2024.10.16

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.

- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

In recent years, the rise of artificial intelligence has introduced AI generators to draft essays and articles. While some people believe this is a valuable tool that can help writers save time and enhance their creativity, others argue that relying on AI undermines the development of writing skills and critical thinking. Do you think AI generators should be restricted? Please explain your reasoning.

Paul:

I think AI generators should be restricted, mainly due to the high risk of plagiarism. Since AI does not always cite its sources, writers could unintentionally use ideas from others without proper attribution. For example, relying too much on AI could result in students facing academic penalties if their work is flagged for unoriginal content.

Jenny:

I believe AI generators should continue to be used because they help writers focus on polishing their work rather than getting stuck on initial drafts. From my experience, AI can highlight mistakes or improve structure. It allows me to spend more time refining their ideas, ultimately producing higher-quality essays.

2024.10.19

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

In this unit, we will be learning about effective strategies for increasing student motivation. Let's begin by discussing one common concern shared by many high school teachers: some of their students typically aged 14 to 18, seem to be bored or uninterested in learning. In your view, what strategy should teachers use to increase high school students' interest in learning? Please explain why you think this one particular strategy will be effective.

Claire:

I believe teachers should incorporate more group work activities into their lessons. While completing tasks in groups or teams, students will have an opportunity to share their opinions and

learn from their peers. Having a sense of belonging is important to teenagers, so being part of a team will likely make them more interested in learning.

Kelly:

In my opinion, teachers should explain how the lessons they teach in the classroom have a connection to events in the world outside high school. Students will likely become more interested in learning once they understand that the lessons can help them be better prepared for future university studies and work.

2024.10.26

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

This week, we will be looking at what governments around the world are doing to improve transportation in large cities. Some governments are expanding roadways, adding lanes to highways, widening other heavily used routes, and even constructing new roads. Other governments are focusing on improvements to public transportation by modernizing existing train and bus systems. Which approach do you think should be the priority in large cities? why?

Claire:

Focusing on public transportation makes the most sense. There is already so much traffic on the roads. Better-quality bus and train services would help reduce the congestion problem by motivating more people to take public transit, which would lead to fewer cars on the road.

Kelly:

Unfortunately, it could take years to modernize a public transit system. If governments want to see improvements in transportation more quickly, it would be better to focus first on upgrading roadways to handle more traffic. This would make car trips more efficient because drivers would spend less time in traffic each day.

2024.10.27

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Next week, we are going to talk about ways to evaluate online sources of information. You know, while there is a lot of information available on the Internet, it is not all equally reliable. Not all the information you find on websites is accurate, and some of it is even intentionally misleading. When looking for information online, what do you think is the best way to determine whether the information is accurate and truthful?

Claire:

If I need to be sure information is accurate, I consult scholarly, peer-reviewed sources like academic journals. If other experts have reviewed the information and approved it, then I know it likely to be reliable. If I have any doubts, I can always ask my professors.

Kelly:

While I agree with Claire to an extent, not all the information you need is available in academic journals. If I need more general information online, I consider the source. Who posts the information to the site? Do they have anything to gain from presenting in accurate information-for example, are they selling a product related to the topic? Asking these kinds of questions is important.

2024.10.30

Your professor is teaching a class on marketing. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Let's continue talking about consumer behavior. We have been discussing different ways people go about choosing what products to buy, and there are many potential sources of information and advice for consumers. In your opinion, which is the better strategy for making purchasing decisions, relying on advice from friends and family, or depending on information from online sources? Why?

Claire:

Asking friends and family members for product recommendations might seem like an easier option, but it might take too much time to get all the information you need. An internet search would be much more efficient. There are many consumer magazines available online that compile lots of data to compare the advantages and disadvantages of one product versus another.

Kelly:

The last time I bought a computer, I just watched a few videos online to make a decision, and now I regret that. My friends could have advised me better because they know my preferences and the kind of features that I am interested in. Consumers should get advice from the people around them to find the most suitable products.

2024.11.2

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

In our upcoming lesson, we will explore the evolution of public health and its impact on the well-being of individuals. Considering the significant progress we've made in healthcare and nutrition, as well as the ongoing challenges such as sedentary lifestyles and stress. I'd like you to reflect on the following question: Do you believe that people are generally healthier now than they were in the past? Why or why not?

Paul:

I believe that people are generally healthier today than they were in the past, and the advancements in medical care play a significant role in longer life expectancy. With the development of new drugs and treatments, we're able to combat illnesses that were once fatal, such as various forms of cancer and heart diseases.

Claire:

While it's true that we've made incredible strides in healthcare and nutrition, the lifestyle-related health issues we face today were less common in the past. It's not just about medical advancements; it's about how we live our lives day to day. The quality of life is being compromised by our poor eating and exercise habits.

2024.11.3

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Let's discuss the role that being on a sports team plays in a child's development. Many argue that playing a team sport, such as basketball, football, or baseball, is an important experience that all children can benefit from in different ways. Conversely, others feel that the focus on team sports for children does more harm than good. What do you think? Is participation in team sports important for a child's development? Why or why not?

Kelly:

Of course, children should participate in team sports! Not everyone is a great student. For many children, team sports are a chance to excel and build their confidence. They can recognize the importance of working hard to accomplish a goal, and this can transfer to other aspects of their lives.

Claire:

I don't think participating in team sports is always a good thing. One reason is the bad behavior of parents during their children's competitions. Too many parents get overly invested and want to win more than their children do. To that end, they will argue with sports officials and referees and set a bad example for their children.

2024.11.13

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

This week, we'll be discussing ways in which schools can help expose their students (aged 5-18) to learning experiences beyond the classroom. Let's begin by discussing one popular idea that some schools are considering -offering outdoor classes once a month. On the day of outdoor classes students will be transported to local parks or nature preserves, and teachers can help students explore nature and learn about the environment. Do you think this is a good idea? Why or why not?

Kelly:

Having outdoor classes once a month seems like an exciting way of providing students with interesting hands-on experiences. However, I don't think these classes would be a worthwhile use of instructional time and school resources. These classes could put substantial pressure on the school's financial resources and on teachers, who may have to redesign their lesson plans.

Andrew:

On the other hand, outdoor classes can increase students' motivation to learn about the interconnectedness of the natural world. These classes could provide great opportunities to teach students about pressing environmental issues, such as pollution, and ways to address these problems. It would deepen their understanding beyond what books alone could achieve and would be time well spent.

2024.11.7

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Ensuring that high school students get the education they need is challenging. Some educators are recognizing that regular classes at school may not be enough to prepare students for careers and for life. Because of this, they recommend that all high school students be required to spend a specific number of hours learning useful skills outside school. Others think that this requirement is not appropriate for all students. Which view do you agree with? Why?

Claire:

I think high school students should not be required to learn skills outside school. School work is already overwhelming for many with exams, projects, and extracurriculars. Adding more would

create unnecessary stress. Life skills can be learned after graduation when students have more time to focus on personal growth.

Andrew:

I believe high school students should be required to learn practical skills outside school. Many lack basic skills like cooking or managing money, which can lead to problems later in life. A friend of mine struggled in college because he didn't know how to budget. If he had learned these skills earlier, he could have avoided unnecessary stress and debt.

2024.11.24

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Studying is an essential part of academic success, but the approach to studying can vary significantly among individuals. Some students prefer studying in groups, believing it allows for collaboration, idea sharing and mutual support. Others find studying alone more effective because it offers fewer distractions and enables a personalized learning pace. Which do you think is more effective: studying in groups or studying alone?

Claire:

I think studying in groups is more effective because it helps build good study habits and prevents procrastination. When I study with others, we set specific goals for each session, which keeps everyone focused and accountable. It's a great way to stay on track and productive.

Paul:

I prefer studying alone because it lets me focus completely without distractions. For example, when I study by myself, I can tailor my pace and methods to what works best for me. Group settings sometimes slow me down or veer off-topic. While collaboration has benefits, I find solo studying more efficient, especially when preparing for exams or tackling challenging subjects.

2024.12.1

Your professor is teaching a class on sociology. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

This week we are talking about how different cities choose to either preserve or replace older, historic buildings. Some cities have strict rules about preserving older buildings and homes, especially those with historic architecture. Others tend to encourage new construction to replace structures that are aging and decaying. Should cities try to save historic buildings or replace them with more modern ones?

Claire:

I think the preservation of old historic buildings involves a lot of problems, especially in densely populated cities. In modern cities, land is very valuable, and old buildings just do not provide as much living and working space as modern high-rise buildings. Also, they were not built to modern standards, so they may waste energy through inefficient heating and cooling.

Paul:

It is important to preserve historic buildings. Keeping original architecture helps preserve a city's culture. Even on the practical side, most big cities get an economic benefit from tourism, and historic buildings like hotels and theaters are big attractions. Who wants to visit a city where all the buildings are glass and steel and look like buildings in every other city?

2024.12.8

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question. In your response, you should do the following:

- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.

An effective response will contain at least 100 words.

Today, we will discuss a topic that is important for students and the public at large: namely, how to prioritize spending, given the limited funding available for schools. Some people think schools should spend more money on school teachers' salaries because it would attract more qualified individuals to the profession. On the other hand, others believe that the money should be allocated

towards additional resources such as books and computers. Which viewpoint do you agree with and why?

Claire:

I believe that increasing teachers's salaries will improve the quality of education. If they earn more money, people will consider teaching as a viable profession rather than opting for private sector jobs. We need the brightest minds in the classrooms.

Paul:

I acknowledge that schoolteachers already earn a decent salary and provide high-quality education. I'm not certain how much of an impact in creasing their salaries would have. Nonetheless, schools always require new equipment or facilities. Knowledge and technology are constantly evolving, and we need to prepare students with the most up-to date materials possible.